

results are opened—under ‘Number of Results’, select a number from 10 to 100 from the drop down box. Obviously, the larger the number, the more time it will take for the results page to load. Tick the Results Window checkbox to open search results in a new browser window.

Content censoring

To ensure that search results do not turn up explicit sexual content, use the SafeSearch option. This can be set under SafeSearch Filtering. Choose from three levels—no filtering, moderate filtering that only blocks explicit images, and strict filtering for explicit text and images.



Make sure all your searches are safe for the family

All across Google

Once set, your Google preferences are maintained throughout all of Google’s services, so between general searches and Google Groups, there are no differences in settings.

AltaVista

AltaVista (www.altavista.com) has powerful search capabilities under its plain and simple skin. It’s one of the

older engines around, but still comes with a bounty of features.

Truly fast searches

While AltaVista is fast, nothing’s ever fast enough! If you want even faster results, switch over to the text-only version at <http://www.altavista.com/web/text>. It’s plain and simple, with no graphical elements to spice up and slow down the page.

Advanced search

Advanced Web searching is accessible from the main page. You can build up queries using exact phrase matches, as well as by the presence or absence of keywords across a page. This is possible from the ‘Build a query with...’ option.

If you’d prefer Boolean operators, the option is avail-

able under ‘Search with...’. Use keywords such as ‘AND’, ‘OR’, ‘AND NOT’ and ‘NEAR’. ‘NEAR’ is used to specify that two terms should be located close together—within 10 words—as in ‘*iit NEAR admissions*’ for a search on ‘IIT admissions’.

Advance advanced

Other Advanced Search options trim your searches. ‘Date’ will limit the date and time-range of the Web pages you are looking for and ‘File-type’ will let you specify the formats. You can also limit searches to specific top-level domains or site domains. Site Collapse, if enabled, will display a maximum of two results per site. If disabled, it will show you all results, grouped by relevance. Results from the same site are indented beneath the first result.

Advanced? Not quite

If you prefer the query-building tool, check out the ‘More Precision’ version of AltaVista at <http://www.altavista.com/?qbmode=>. You don’t get all the advanced features, but you do have access to the query-building options.

Wildcarding

AltaVista supports wildcard characters; use [*] to get search results based on variations of words. This is how it works: there have to be at least three letters before the [*] sign. Remember, any letter or letters can take the place of the wildcard character, so a search for ‘Micro*’ can result in ‘Micro’, ‘Micron’, ‘Microsoft’, ‘Microscope’, ‘Microscopic’, and so on.

Preferences

Click on Settings on the main page to set your preferences. You can choose to set language settings (English or

AltaVista Keywords

Keyword/Symbol	Usage	Action
AND	<i>Custard AND Apple</i>	Looks for pages containing both the words (any order, anywhere in the page)
OR	<i>Custard OR Apple</i>	Looks for pages containing both the words, if not at least one
AND NOT	<i>Custard AND NOT Apple</i>	Results served up contain ‘Custard’, but not ‘Apple’
[*]	<i>Col*r</i>	Looks for pages containing both ‘Colour’ and ‘Color’
domain	<i>domain:edu</i>	Finds documents from the .edu domain
Image	<i>image:boating</i>	Finds pages that feature an image called boating
Like	<i>like:ebay.com</i>	Finds sites that are similar in content to eBay, the auction site

See the complete list at http://www.altavista.com/help/adv_search/syntax



The true strength of AltaVista is its Advanced Search



Virus Alerts, Bug Fixes, Patches, Security

Virus Workshop

www.zdnetindia.com/virus